participants disrupt the institutions they inhabit. These disruptions often occur through withholding critical resources and fostering toxic environments, behaviors labeled as “organizational deviance” or “workplace aggression” (Likert 1967; Pfeffer and Salancik 1978). However, when applied to IOs, this framework becomes more complex, as both domestic and international dynamics come into play. This section outlines general tactics hostile actors use to harm organizations, adapting these insights to the unique context of IOs. While not exhaustive, it highlights key strategies populists use to destabilize these bodies.

It is worth noting that many of these tactics are not exclusive to populists; nonpopulist actors also employ them when they wish to weaken IOs. However, populists’ resistance is often more systematic and has stronger ideological underpinnings. Their persistent willingness to challenge IOs stems from the lower political and ideological costs they face when disengaging from or undermining these bodies.

A primary way hostile actors disrupt IOs is by withholding resources, a tactic organizational sociology identifies as critical to undermining an institution’s vitality. One such resource is effort—the basic engagement required for an organization to function. Hostile actors may intentionally underperform, withhold expertise, or refuse to contribute to collective goals (Robinson and Bennett 1995; Lawrence and Robinson 2007). These behaviors not only stymie productivity but also tarnish the organization’s reputation and effectiveness (Fombrun and Shanley 1990; Ambrose, Seabright, and Schminke 2002).

Effort withdrawal often manifests as noncompliance, wherein actors challenge institutional authority, disregard its rules, or actively obstruct organizational processes (O’Leary 2010). This type of resistance disrupts IOs’ ability to coordinate and execute initiatives, leaving them vulnerable to both internal dysfunction and external criticism. Indeed, compliance, performance, and reputation are often tightly interconnected (Heinzel and Liese 2021).

Another critical resource in this context is information and communication, which hostile actors can exploit to create confusion and mistrust. Tactics such as spreading misinformation, circulating rumors, and selectively disclosing information undermine trust within the organization (Kramer 1999; Bordia et al. 2006). These actions fuel toxic communication